TOOL 07

Knowledge Chat

Paste a client email, get the right answer with sources

What it does

- Holds everything your business knows in one place: products, prices, spec sheets, FAQs and team notes.
- Sorts it all into categories by itself, like "Cameras", "Trackers" and "Software plans".
- Checks a few government websites on a schedule, so it learns when a rule changes.
- You paste a client's email. It writes a reply with the best picks, why each one fits and a link for more info.
- It shows where every answer came from, so you can check it before you hit send.
- When nothing fits, or it doesn't know, it says so. It never makes up an answer.

Why it's built this way

One box, one button. You paste the email and click "Draft reply". Your team doesn't need training.

It drafts. You send. The chat never emails the client. A person reads the reply, checks the sources and sends it. That one step catches most mistakes.

It answers only from your own files. AI chats want you to like them. When they don't know something, they guess, and the guess sounds like a fact. So this one gets three hard rules it must follow on every answer:

1. Only answer from the knowledge base. No outside knowledge.
2. Cite the source for every pick, price or rule.
3. If nothing fits or you're not sure, say "I don't know." Never guess.

"I don't know" is a feature. Each "I don't know" tells you something is missing from your files. Add it, and next time the chat knows.

Government sites are checked on a timer. Once a day or once a week is enough. New rules show up as a yellow "read before sending" note on any reply they affect.

What you need

- A Claude or ChatGPT account to build it. A paid plan (about $20 a month) handles long code better.

- An AI API account (Anthropic or OpenAI) so the chat can write replies. You pay per answer.
- A free hosting account, such as Vercel, to put the app online.
- A database with search, such as Supabase. The free plan is fine to start.
- Your files: product lists, price sheets, spec sheets and FAQs. PDF, Word, Excel and plain text all work.
- About one to two weekends.

Rough running cost:

- Each answer costs about 10 to 50 cents. A small knowledge base sits near 10 cents. A big one with long documents can reach 50.
- 300 answers a month cost about $30 to $150.
- Hosting and the database can be free at small size, or about $25 to $45 a month as you grow.

Build it step by step

Paste these prompts into Claude, ChatGPT or Claude Code one at a time. Test after each step before you go on.

1 Plan it

COPY THIS PROMPT

```
I want an internal "knowledge chat" for my sales team. We paste a client's
email and it drafts a reply using ONLY our own product files. I am not a coder.
Plan a simple web app: pages, where the data lives, which AI to use, and the
monthly cost. Ask me 5 questions first.
```

2 Build the chat screen

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```
Build version 1 as a Next.js web app. One page: a big "Client question" box,
a "Draft reply" button and a reply area with a Copy button. Use fake answers
for now. Tell me exactly how to run it on my computer.
```

3 Load your knowledge

COPY THIS PROMPT

```
Add a "Knowledge base" page to upload PDF, Word, Excel and text files. Split
each file into small chunks and save them in a searchable database (Supabase is
fine). Let the AI sort each file into one of these categories: [your list].
Show a table of files and their category.
```

4 Connect the AI with three hard rules

COPY THIS PROMPT

```
Make "Draft reply" real. Find the 10 chunks that best match the question and
ask the AI for a short, friendly reply. Add these hard rules:
1) Answer only from the chunks provided.
2) For every product or price, name the source it came from.
3) If the chunks don't answer the question, start the reply with "I don't know"
and explain what is missing. Never guess.
Show the sources used under the reply.
```

5 Test that it refuses to guess

COPY THIS PROMPT

```
Write 10 test questions: 5 our files can answer and 5 they can't. The 5 it
can't answer must start with "I don't know". Give me one button to run all 10
and show pass or fail.
```

6 Add government sites

COPY THIS PROMPT

```
Add a "Government sites" page where I paste up to 5 web addresses. Once a day,
check each page. If it changed, ask the AI for a 2-sentence summary, save it as
a "rule update" and use it in matching replies, with a link to the source.
```

7 Show the cost of each answer

COPY THIS PROMPT

```
Log what every reply cost in dollars. Show "This answer cost $0.xx" under it.
Add a "Usage" page with the monthly total and the average cost per answer.
```

8 Lock it down and put it online

COPY THIS PROMPT

```
Add a login so only my team can use it. Then walk me through putting it
online on Vercel. Keep API keys in environment variables, never in the code.
```

Make it yours

- **Pick your own categories.** Use the words your clients use, like "Cold storage", "Rentals" or "Spare parts".
- **Add your tone.** Paste three of your best real emails and ask the AI to match their style.

- **Answer in the client's language.** Ask it to reply in the same language the email was written in.
- **Hide team-only notes.** Mark some files "internal" so their numbers help your team but never go into a client reply.

Watch out for

- **AI making things up.** Even with rules, it can slip. Always read the sources before you send. Run your 10 test questions after every change.
- **Old rules and prices.** The chat only knows what you give it. Set a reminder to update price lists, and check the government site list every month. Sites move pages and links break.
- **Costs creeping up.** Long files and big searches cost more per answer. Set a monthly budget and look at the usage page every week.
- **Private data.** Don't upload client passports, bank details or anything you would not email. Keep the app behind a login.
- **Too many "I don't know" answers.** That's normal at first. Each one points to a missing file. Fill the gap and the chat gets smarter.